

FATHER SOLANUS, NOTEBOOK No. 2

Pg. 44 June 1st 1917 First Friday Early First Communion
 "Suffer the Little Children to come to me and forbid
 -not"
 It is the ardent desire of the Church and of the
 Sacred Heart of Jesus Himself that frequently and
 with great zeal we be reminded of the untold treas-
 ures of Holy Communion. The general intention for
 this month, "Early 1st Communion" is a phase of
 this subject which, in the interest of the Sacred
 Heart and of the little children we will briefly
 consider this evening. "Suffer the little children
 What a beautiful expression and how tender! What an
 authoritative ring to these words of our Divine Master!
 They contain at once a command, an appeal, an ex-
 hortation. "Suffer the little Nor can we be
 surprised that Jesus speaks with such spirit in this
 connection - in connection with the very lambs of His
 flock. The greatest characters of every nation and
 of every age - men and women alike - have been
 friends of the children, have loved them, have pro-
 tected them, have espoused the cause of the little
 children and shall Jesus be less loving, less af-
 fectionate? Their very weakness appeals to every
 noble heart. Their innocence, their candor, their
 simplicity, their disposition to love and to for-
 give inspires sympathy and parental solicitude
 wherever a spark of humanity is left. But more than
 this; every one knows that the future of society
 depends on the children of Today. If the saying
 is true that "the boy is father to the man," then
 we likewise say that "the little children are the
 parents of youth." If child-hood be sanctified as
 Jesus would sanctify it, youth can not but be holy.
 If youth is holy man-hood will surely be noble -
 and vice versa. As the lily or the rose unprotected
 in the bud will bloom forth - if it blooms at all -
 will bloom forth blighted in every petal, so with
 men and women whose child-hood has been neglected,
 whose youth has been spoiled. "As the sprig is
 bent so shall it grow." And we may add here, as
 believers in eternal reward and punishment - "as
 the tree is inclined so shall it fall." Man was created
 not simply and solely for society. He was created for
 Heaven as well. "God made me..." If I fail in this